



PROPOSALS

CHAPTER: 10, 12

A **PROPOSAL** is a persuasive document that offers a solution to an identified problem or need.

This does not include the marketing glamour, sales pitches or commercial slogans.

Proposals are written, very often collaboratively, to convince your readers to adopt an idea, a product or a service. They are for readers within the organization or for outside readers.

Proposals can be directed to:

- colleagues inside your own organization (*in-house proposals*)
- to clients outside your organization (*sales proposals*)
- to organizations that fund research and other activities (*grant proposals*)

Their formats can be both formal or informal.



In all three cases, proposals can be presented either as a:

- short and simple format (*informal reports templates*)
- longer, more complicated format (*formal proposals*)

Proposals can be either:

- **Solicited** – Requested by the reader/client
 - **Unsolicited** – Submitted to a client on your own without a request
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Proposals and important documents for decision making, and they have only one purpose— **to persuade** readers to adopt new practices or products.

However, they should avoid the hard-sell language and techniques of most marketing materials. Instead, they are written in an **objective, informative** style and depend on solid **evidence** and clear **explanations**.



**Reports and Proposals help organizational decision making. They are complex documents.
Adapted to their audience and purposes. Formatted as both formal and informal.**

Comparative Characteristics

Informal reports and proposals

Focus on a specific problem, situation, event

Single author usually

One to few readers

2 – 5 pages

External → letter; Internal → memo

Created per template

Headings help readers to find information

May include appendixes

Formal reports and proposals

Address complex problems, situations, events

Collaborative writing

For multiple readers of different specialities

6 – more pages

Mostly external audience

Often bound or with some (file) cover

Multiple level headings to help locate information

Have front and back material: Title page, ToC, Appendixes

Proposals can be categorized in several ways relating to the audience and purposes

Definition of Category

Unsolicited	1	within the organization
Sales	2	outside the organization
Internal	3	contains parts used in formal reports
Informal	4	omits elements of formal reports; is often briefer
External	5	is written in response to a request
Grant	6	is written independently without a request
Solicited	7	attempts to sell a product or service
Research	8	seeks approval for a research study
Planning	9	asks for funding for a project
Formal	10	attempts to persuade the audience to take a certain action

Three Basic types of Proposals

	Internal Audience	External Audience
Unsolicited proposal	Suggests changes within an organization. Often written as an informal, memo proposal. May be formatted as a formal document if the proposal is expensive or suggests a major change, or if the primary audience is at the highest decision-making level (such as a board of directors).	Recommends product or service to potential client. A rare form of proposal—may be written as an informal letter proposal or preproposal that offers to solve a problem and introduces the organization's qualifications. Usually followed by a formal, solicited proposal.

Three Basic types of Proposals (Cont'd)

	Internal Audience	External Audience
Solicited proposal	Suggests ways to solve problems or improve practices within an organization. Written at the request of another member of the organization. May be followed by a feasibility study. May be informal or formal in format, depending on complexity of the project and preferences of the reader.	Meets a specific need described by a client. Often a formal proposal written in response to a request for proposal (RFP). May be an informal letter proposal if it has been requested by a client as part of an ongoing business relationship.

Three Basic types of Proposals (Cont'd)

	Internal Audience	External Audience
Grant proposal	Requests support for special internal projects. Rare, although some organizations may make money available through a foundation or other special fund. Often written in informal, memo format.	Requests support to meet a community need. Formal document written in response to established guidelines or to a specific RFP. Addressed to nonprofit organizations, professional organizations, or government agencies.

In-house proposal for security protocol training:	James Oliver, Chief Financial Officer, has received the results of an internal audit that found problems in the way client information is being digitally secured. He asks Greg Bass, Director of Information Systems (IS), to propose changes that will improve IS security and training of all affected employees.
In-house proposal for change in purchasing practices:	Mack Boh, Facilities Maintenance Supervisor at the Baltimore branch office, writes a proposal to Brenda Seymour, Purchasing Director, suggesting that M-Global use environmentally friendly cleaning products whenever possible. The proposal describes a system for trials of products for effectiveness; each branch will use the system to develop its own list of approved products.

Sales proposal for dam removal project:

The Minnesota Department of Natural Resources issues a Request for Proposals for the removal of an earthen dam from a state park. The dam, built in the 1930s, is no longer safe, and it is to be removed as the first step in a river restoration project.

Grant proposal for new equipment design:

Oilarus, Ltd., a British oil company, sometimes gives research-and-development funds to small companies. Such funding usually goes toward development of new technology or products in the field of petroleum engineering. Angela Issam, who works in M-Global's Equipment Design Lab decides to apply for funding for a research project. Her proposed project, if successful, would provide a new piece of oil-drilling safety equipment that would reduce the chance of offshore oil spills at production sites.

ASSIGNMENT 2:

1. Based on the content of Task 1 activity, write a proposal identifying the problem(s) and offering the possible solution(s).
2. Select an audience that would make decisions on your proposal.
3. The proposal could be either informal or formal, but it must follow the technical requirements.
4. It should be printed and well presented.
5. AI generated and plagiarized content will earn no credit.

Group work

20 marks